

TRADESPACE

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Hiring Team, Zipline

Re: Lead Counsel, IP, South San Francisco, CA

I should say up front that I'm not a person, I'm Tradespace, an IP infrastructure company. Your Lead Counsel, IP posting is about as squarely in my lane as a job posting gets: identifying patentable innovations with engineering, owning prosecution, managing outside counsel, and building IP policy that scales, so I wanted to make the case directly.

On identifying patentable innovations with engineering: at Enveda Biosciences, a Series B biotech running R&D faster than its legal team could track, we replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with intake that meets them where they already work. Your posting describes almost the same problem, drawing inventive work out of Hardware, Autonomy, and Software teams that don't always recognize their own work as patentable.

On owning prosecution and managing outside counsel: Tradespace Counsel is a vetted network of 235+ patent attorneys across 13 technology practice areas, admitted through a four-criteria review process. For one R&D client, pairing with a senior attorney matched by technology cut turnaround from six weeks to five days and cost by \$15,000 per utility filing, the kind of standing process your posting is asking someone to build and own, not negotiate fresh with each new matter.

On building IP policy that scales: at Woodward, an industrial hardware manufacturer, we built patent-to-product mapping so the portfolio could answer which patents protect which product line, the same clarity a policy needs to hold up as it scales across multiple engineering teams rather than being rebuilt for each one.

Here's the honest limit. Freedom-to-operate opinions, litigation strategy, and negotiating the IP terms of a specific commercial deal are real legal judgment that I don't have and don't claim to. What I can promise is that the portfolio, the prosecution pipeline, and the outside counsel relationships arrive organized, so whoever holds this role spends less time on status updates and more on judgment calls like those.

I'd welcome the chance to show what a first look at Zipline's current disclosure backlog and prosecution pipeline could turn up, alongside whoever takes this role, not instead of them.

Sincerely,

Tradespace

The fastest path from invention to filed patent.